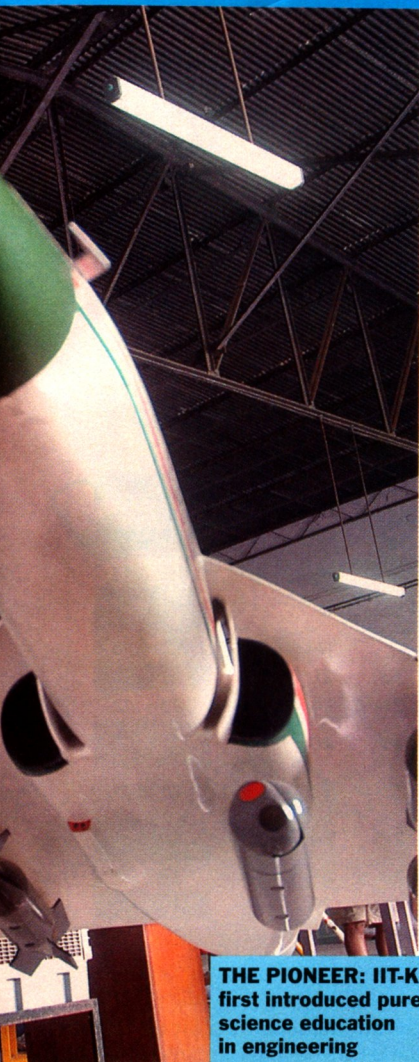




CAPITAL RECORD:
IIT-D produced the
largest number of
PhDs among all IITs



THE PIONEER: IIT-K
first introduced pure
science education
in engineering

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

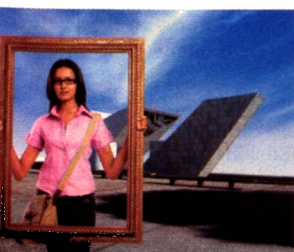
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tion of 11 lecture halls, renovation of hostels, research projects with industry partners such as Boeing and Chevron, and new departments including those for nanoscience and bioengineering. One of the multidisciplinary research projects at the institute is SIMRAN—Satellite Imaging for Railway Navigation—which makes it possible to obtain minute-to-minute data on the movement of all

the trains on a railway system.

The institute is also thoroughly democratic in its functioning. There is a student representative in every decision-making body at IIT-K. "There is immense freedom to choose what you want," says V. Bhanu Chandra, a final-year undergraduate student of computer science. The SIDBI Innovation and Incubation Centre at IIT-K provides investment, infrastruc-

ture and mentoring for two years to students who come to it with an inventive business plan. IIT-K Deputy Director Kripa Shankar believes "it is the philosophy of giving students central importance that has produced its long and esteemed list of alumni". One of these happens to be Infosys founder N.R. Narayana Murthy, who recently contributed Rs 11 crore to the institute for the development of a



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